

LESSON 2 — Research (Benchmarking)

- For each case you study, ask:
- What is this game/experience? (describe in 3–5 lines)
- What type is it? (board game, app, museum interactive, etc.)
- Who is it for? (audience + context of use)
- What is the main content/theme?
- How is the content presented? (narrative, puzzle, simulation, etc.)
- Is the content truly integrated or just decorative?
- What are the physical components?
- What are the digital components?
- How are physical and digital parts connected?
- What do users actually do? (observe, solve, compete, collaborate, etc.)
- Is it single player, collaborative, or competitive?
- What works well?
- Why is it useful for our project?
- What specific element could we borrow?
- How could it inspire our museum photographer game?
- Rate it 1–5 on: clarity, interaction, integration, museum relevance, learning value, collaboration, use of media, overall effectiveness

LESSON 3 — Game Concept

Audience:

- Who are the 3 possible target audiences for our game?
- Why does each audience make sense?

Focus:

- What is our one main photographic focus? (observation, framing, composition, etc.)
- Why does this focus fit Palazzo Poggi / Aldrovandi?

Metaphor:

- What is our chosen metaphor? (investigation, scientific observation, evidence gathering, etc.)
- Why does this metaphor work?
- What does this metaphor help players understand or do?

Challenges:

- What is Challenge 1 — title, what players do, which photo concept, why it fits the museum, collaborative or competitive?
- What is Challenge 2 — same structure?
- What is Challenge 3 — same structure?

LESSON 4 — Museum Visit & Grounding

Mission review:

- Which of our missions worked best as a player experience?
- Is our mission valid for the game?
- What did it teach us about photography?

- What did it teach us about the museum / heritage?
- What did it teach us about designing challenges?
- How could it be turned into game design?
- What should players understand differently after playing?
- What is worth keeping — mechanic, clue system, roles, narrative structure?

Heritage assets:

- Which museum objects, rooms, or details are most relevant for our game?
- Which aspects of photography are most important for the game?

Attention:

- What attracts visitor attention in the museum?
- What distracts visitors?

Opportunities:

- What could become a challenge, clue, obstacle, mission, or mechanic?
- What should our game avoid misrepresenting or oversimplifying?

Institutional goals:

- What is the museum's primary institutional goal?
- What is the museum's secondary institutional goal?
- What is the primary photography learning goal?
- What is the secondary photography learning goal?

PACT:

- What should we remember about our audience in the museum? (People)
- What is the main activity players/visitors will perform? (Activities)
- Which contextual condition matters most? (Context)
- What device or media condition is most relevant? (Technologies)

Synthesis:

- In one sentence — what does our game help players do?
- In one sentence — what does our game help the museum achieve?
- In one sentence — what did our museum visit confirm?

LESSON 5 — Final Design & Board Structure

Design Brief:

- What is our one-sentence game concept?
- What is our heritage thesis? (the main cultural idea/claim of the game)
- What is the primary institutional goal?
- What is the primary audience goal?
- What is the support goal?
- What is the optional goal?
- What should players **learn**?
- What should players **feel**?
- What should **change** after the experience?
- Why is this meaningful for Palazzo Poggi / Aldrovandi?
- What are our main design constraints? (space, time, access, devices, museum rules)

- What is the minimum viable experience — the simplest version that still works?
- Complete: *"Our game helps [audience] to ___ while engaging with [star asset] through ___"*

Master Photographer Profile:

- What is our Core Mastery Dimension 1? (seeing, technical control, point of view, timing, editing, culture, revealing meaning)
- Why is this central to our game?
- What is our Core Mastery Dimension 2?
- Why is this central to our game?
- What is our Secondary Mastery Dimension?
- How does it support the experience?
- Which mastery dimensions become **visible player actions**?
- Which mastery dimensions become **success criteria**?
- Which mastery dimensions become **progression or end goals**?

Board Study (from existing game):

- Which board game did we analyse?
- What is always visible to all players on that board?
- What is tracked on that board?
- What stays off the board?
- How does that board organise progression, tension, or shared decisions?
- What can we borrow from that board structure?
- What would NOT fit our museum game?

Your Own Board:

- What is the main function of our board? (map / mission tracker / evidence organiser / progression system / collaborative decision space / hybrid)
- What does our board help players do?
- What must stay visible to ALL players at all times?
- Why do these elements belong on the board?
- What should be handled through **cards**?
- What should be handled through **tokens/markers/pieces**?
- What should happen through the **phone or digital layer**?
- What other objects might be needed?
- What will players do repeatedly?
- Why is this a **game** and not just an experience?

Component List:

- What are the board zones/areas?
- What types of cards are needed?
- What tokens/markers/pieces are needed?
- What phone/digital functions are needed?

- What other objects are needed?
- Draw a rough sketch of the board

Final Synthesis:

- Our final design brief in one sentence?
- Our board should make visible — what exactly?
- Our game will probably need these components — list them
- What is the next step for our concept?

For EVERY lesson, also answer:

- Did we use any AI tools?
- What was the purpose?
- What prompt/input did we give?
- How did we evaluate or modify the output?

Quick Summary of the Journey

Stage Core Question

L2 What already exists that we can learn from?

L3 What is our game concept and logic?

L4 What did the real museum teach us?

L5 What exactly are we building and how?

Answer all 100 questions across the 4 lessons and you will have everything needed to complete the full project.